Gmail

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Reflections from Beyond the Bend

1 message

Beyond The Bend Yoga <laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca> Mon, Oct 27, 2025 at 3:33 PM
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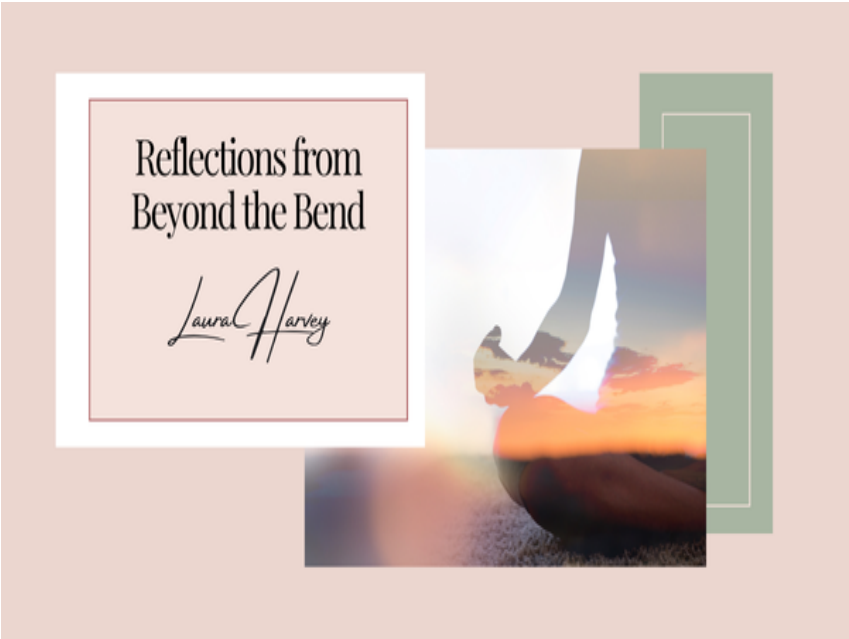
BEYOND THE BEND YOGA



Hi Laura

Have you ever noticed how loud the mind can become the very moment we decide we want quiet? It's almost comical, really. It's like the brain senses an opportunity for stillness and panics, suddenly offering us grocery lists, old conversations, future worries, and completely unnecessary commentary about that thing we said ten years ago.

For so many of us, peace sounds beautiful in theory… until we sit down to actually feel it. Then the inner chatter begins, and we assume something must be wrong with *us*.

But recently, I've been remembering something gentler, something the body seems to know even when the mind forgets:
We don't have to wrestle with our thoughts to find calm. We don't have to shush them, solve them, or turn them into something profound.

We can simply witness them.

Just as we watch clouds drift through a wide, patient sky, we can let our thoughts float through without clinging. The sky never panics about the storm. It doesn't hurry the weather. It simply holds everything - rain, sun, cloud, thunder - without ever losing its own vastness.

And so can we.

When we soften our grip and create the tiniest bit of space, something subtle shifts. The noise doesn't disappear, but *our relationship* with it does. We begin to remember that behind every swirl of thought, there is a steady place inside us that doesn't move. A quiet seat of awareness we can return to again and again - not by force, but by invitation.

It's in those quiet returns that peace finds us.

With warmth and gratitude,
Laura 💗

This Week's Wellness Wisdom

The Space Between Thoughts

By Laura Harvey | Beyond the Bend Yoga

Our minds are extraordinary. They are capable of imagining futures that don’t yet exist, remembering moments that have long passed, and weaving meaning from the simplest of things. They are creative, protective, curious, and deeply human.

But left unchecked, they can become very loud roommates.

Most of us are never taught how to relate to our thoughts. We spend years believing every storyline that arises, assuming that if the mind presents something - like a worry, a narrative, or a prediction - it must be important, and true.

Yet the mind has a habit of filling every quiet pause with noise. It rehearses, replays, evaluates, judges, and tries to predict what might go wrong. Not because we’re broken, but because somewhere along the way, it learned that staying busy feels safer than being still.

When we start to recognize this pattern - when we simply notice the hum of mental activity - something subtle and incredible happens. We

create just the smallest bit of space. And in that space, we reconnect with something older and steadier than all of our thoughts combined: the quiet presence underneath them.

Imagine a stream winding gently through a forest. Thoughts are like leaves drifting on its surface. Some are bright and beautiful - joyful memories, creative sparks, warm plans. Others are heavy and tangled - doubts, old fears, unfinished conversations.

Our habit is to grab at them:
to chase the beautiful
to resist the uncomfortable
to try to make sense of every single leaf.

But the stream keeps moving, whether we chase the leaves or not.

And when we practice letting them pass, something remarkable occurs: the water becomes clear again. We begin to see through the noise instead of from within it.

Here's the important truth:
We don't need to *stop* thinking. Thoughts are part of being alive. Meditation and mindfulness aren't about silencing the mind, they're about softening our attachment with every storyline it creates.

We are not our thoughts.
We are the awareness witnessing them.

When thinking slows, even for a breath or two, many people report a quiet sense of wellbeing. It's not dramatic. It's not performative. It's a gentle rightness, like remembering something you knew all along. Colors feel a bit richer. The body loosens. The breath becomes your ally again.

That feeling isn't created by silence.
It's revealed when the noise settles.

The beauty of this practice is that it is simple. You don't need hours of meditation or perfect conditions. You don't need to retreat to a mountaintop or shush the mind into obedience.

All you need is notice.

Notice the rushing thoughts.
Notice the story.
Notice the pull of the past or the lure of the future.

And then - very gently - return to the present moment.
To the way your breath moves.
To the weight of your body on the chair.

To the weight of your body on the chair.
To the temperature of the air on your skin.
To one single sound in your environment.

Each return is like watering a quiet garden inside you.

And over time, we trust something profound:
Peace is not something we must earn.
It’s not waiting somewhere else.
It’s not conditional.

It’s always here - beneath the swirl and spin of thinking - like the sky patiently holding every cloud.

Our work is not to eliminate the clouds, but simply to remember the sky.

✨ Edmonton Friends:
A Mid-Week Morning Sanctuary Awaits

If your nervous system has been longing for a softer start to the day - a moment to exhale before the world begins pulling at your attention - I would love to welcome you to **Morning Stillness: A Gentle Hatha Practice**, beginning **this Wednesday**.

We gather inside the **Center for Spiritual Living** — a breathtaking sanctuary with high ceilings, stained glass windows, and a labyrinth beneath our feet. The space itself feels like an invitation to slow down. People tell me they can feel their shoulders drop the moment they walk through the door.

🗓️ **Wednesdays**
⏰ **10:00–11:15 AM**
📍 **Center for Spiritual Living Edmonton**

💸 **Investment options:**
• *8-week session*: $17 per class (total $136)
• *Drop-ins*: $20 per class
Come weekly for deeper grounding, or join whenever your schedule allows — both are welcome.

You don't need experience or flexibility — just curiosity and a willingness to pause. And because this sanctuary offers plenty of space, there's no stress about overcrowding. Come as you are, when you can.

If you're unsure about committing to the full session, try one morning and see how your body feels afterward. Some of the most meaningful shifts happen quietly, without fanfare.

✨ **Click the button below** for details and to save your spot
(or simply reply to this email — I'll happily add you myself)

If your breath just softened, even a little, consider this your invitation.

With warmth and gratitude,
Laura 💗

Learn More and Sign-up

✨ Upcoming Classes

🌸 Sherwood Park - Rising Moon Studio

Evening Classes

- **Monday Evenings – Somatic Vinyasa (6:00–7:15 p.m.)**
  Next 7-week session: ***November 3 – December 15***
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- **Tuesday Evenings – Restore and Reclaim (6:00–7:15 p.m.)**
  Next 7-week session: ***November 4 – December 16***

Drop-ins are available for Current Classes - Please Contact Laura at laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca

Morning Classes

- **Tuesday Mornings – Rise and Restore (10:00–11:15 a.m.)**
  October 21 – December 16 (9-week series)

Learn More and Sign-up

🌿 Practice of the Week: Watching the Stream

Before you begin, take a moment to read through this practice once so you know the flow. When you're ready, find a comfortable seat and settle in. Then, close your eyes and move through the imagery from memory as best you can. There's no need to get it "perfect" - simply let the practice unfold gently as it does.

Sit comfortably, allowing your spine to lengthen with ease.
Close your eyes or soften your gaze and take a slow breath in through the nose… and a long, gentle exhale through the mouth.

Feel your body settling, supported by the ground beneath you.

Now, imagine yourself beside a gentle forest stream.
Hear the water flowing at its own steady pace, cool and clear.

As thoughts arise - memories, plans, worries, surprises - imagine placing each one on a leaf and setting it onto the water. Watch as the current carries it downstream.

Pause for a few breaths.

Don't try to chase the leaves.
Don't try to make them disappear.
Just let the stream carry them.

If you notice the mind wandering (and it will), gently return to the stream.
That moment of noticing?
That's awareness returning and the heart of this practice.

Pause for another few breaths.

After a few minutes, let the scene fade softly.
Open your eyes and take one more slow, grounding breath.

Notice how your body feels.
Notice how your thoughts feel a little less sticky, and how the world feels just a touch more spacious.

🌿 Quick Version (for your pocket):

- Sit, breathe, soften.
- Place each thought on a leaf.
- Watch it drift downstream.
- Return to breath when you notice you're thinking

- Return to breath when you notice you're thinking.

That's it.
Simple. Gentle. Enough.

🌙 A Closing Thought

In a world that pulls us in a thousand directions, stillness can feel like a luxury - but it is, in truth, a necessity. Each time you pause, even for a breath, you remind your body that it is safe to soften. You remind your heart that it's allowed to rest.

Peace doesn't arrive with fanfare. It shows up quietly, in the subtle space between thoughts when we're willing to notice.

May this week offer you small moments of spaciousness.
May you trust the stream to carry what no longer needs your grip.
And may you remember that the quiet place within you is never lost - only waiting.

With warmth and gratitude,
Laura 💗

Our e-mail address is:
laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca

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You can unsubscribe from this list.